

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Digital Video

You've suddenly found yourself in a café in the Art District and have no clue how you got there—it happens to the best of us. You are bored for company and are wondering how to break into the group of digital video (DV) geeks in the corner.

"CMOS or CCD?" one of them asks after you exchange names. CCDs are Charge Coupled Devices, used for image sensing. The best digital cameras use 3-CCD arrangements to get top-quality video, and cost you half a kingdom. And CMOS (Complimentary Metal Oxide Semiconductor) is a cheaper but slightly lower-quality approach to image sensing, but it's getting better.

Just say, "Oh CCD, no doubt. No compromises on quality", this will have them swooning at your discerning eye and bottomless wallet (Ahem!).

Regular video is interlaced—the image is divided into two sets of lines that are displayed alternately to fool the human eye into believing it's seeing a high-quality image. Progressive Scanned video displays all these lines in sequence, storing five times as much information in the frame. The result is High Definition Video (HDV), where faster movements appear much crisper than in interlaced video.

Video usually runs at 24 frames per second (fps). Saying "I'm shooting my next with a 24P camera" means that your video will run at 24 fps and is progressively scanned, and roughly translates to "I'm a George Lucas in the making!"

DV25 is the standard compression format for DV; an hour of DV25 video takes up about 13 GB of space and is the best possible quality outside of raw, uncompressed video. MPEG-2 is another compression format that started out as a format for distribution, but is now used in recording as well.

"Real Men don't compress," you scoff, leaving them burling something about more video on the same tape while you beckon a cab to take you home.

Happy New Year!

Passion and fun, spunk and luck, laughter and sorrow, excitement and disappointment—our team's melting pot of emotions has this and more!

The month started in the worst way possible: in the first week itself we were shocked to find out that a dear ex-colleague of ours, Marshall Mascharenas, formerly the Art Director of *Digit*, succumbed to cancer. He was a dedicated and talented soul, and our entire team's hearts and wishes go out to his wife and daughter. He will be sorely missed!

There were also changes in the team—Mithun left to pursue his calling in creative copywriting, while, our self-confessed book-addict Renuka is off to study literature. Of the new joiners, we have Jyotsna on the copy desk. Articulate and a pro at English, Jyotsna surely must have been the winner of the spelling bee! Another newcomer, tech-whiz Nimish has fit in so perfectly with our team, that we all insisted he should bring along a clone of his—the more the merrier! And yes, Prakash from Bangalore has joined us on the CD/DVD front.

As for the goings-on in the team, the

test centre seems to have come to where we sit: there's non-stop gaming here these days, mostly courtesy Raaabo. A true-blue gamer, anytime you hear jets whizzing past or firearms going off non-stop accompanied by loud screams, it's only Raaabo at his FPS on a cataclysmic mission with a mad glint in his eyes.

And talking about gaming, the layout and design artists at *Digit* cannot help but pay daily obeisance to *Zuma Devi*—the stone frog idol in the insanely addictive *Zuma Deluxe* game.

And yes, it's the time for New Year resolutions. A few guys here—Ram and Vijay included—are trying to kick the nicotine addiction (as they do every year). Shival says he will not shout for "high-resolution images" anymore. We in turn are trying not to call Brother Zivalal "Zony Ericsson". Needless to say, these resolutions will barely last for a day!

And editor Deepak plans to increase his tech quotient. Honestly, we all do. For technology can be overwhelming for the best of us. And as we continue to navigate through its waters—2006 will be the year!

DIGIT DIARY

PARENT COMPANIES?

My Dad's Surname Is .com!

A Web hosting company by the name of Weblinkhosting.com has applied for the right to legally adopt a child. This means that the child will be parented by the company, and not by an individual.

Weblinkhosting wants to adopt a child and raise it in its data centre, where the child will be cared for by various employees and provided with food, clothes and shelter.

Since every employee will be like a parent, the child will receive more love than in any normal house!

The company hopes that the child will grow in a conducive environment and learn all there is to know about Web hosting and become a Linux guru.

Though viewed as a publicity stunt by the media, the fact is that, thus far, there have been no impediments in the application procedure, which has taken almost six months.

Though Weblinkhosting hasn't decided on the nationality or the age of the child yet, it plans to do so soon. As for the sex of the child, that will be decided

by the flip of a coin!

We hope this doesn't become a trend, because of all the social repercussions: imagine companies building recruits by hiring toddlers, training them and then absorbing them into the workforce!

Though this sounds like a good idea, it might not be really fair to a child, who deserves the freedom of choice, once of age.

Children adopted by companies will differ from us, simply because we have the freedom of choice when it comes to deciding our own careers.

Whereas, the child who may be adopted by Weblinkhosting might not have that choice because of the "brainwashing" he or she will be subjected to while growing up.

What if the child really wanted to become a hairdresser or a doctor? Is it fair to manipulate a child in such a way?

STEALTHTEXT

Self Destructing SMSes?

With all the leaks and scandals regarding mobile content that we have seen